

DIRECTORY



Any list of the greatest movies of all time, whether it is 10, 100, or 1,000 titles long, will inevitably be subjective in both its selections and omissions. Indeed, much of the fun of the debate comes from the disagreements it provokes. This section features a selection of the movies that came close to being included in the main section, but did not quite make the final cut. It is, like the main list, subjective in nature, but helps fill some of the inevitable gaps. Spread widely across time, place, and genre, the list provides additional samples from world cinema over the last century or so, a selection of movies to celebrate and to argue over, to watch and to rewatch. Each movie title is followed by the director's name and the year the movie was released.

THE GREAT TRAIN ROBBERY

Edwin S. Porter, 1903

This 12-minute short was possibly the first Western, with cowboys, six-shooters, and a rowdy saloon. The robbers use a fake telegraph to stop the train, rob the safe, and hold up the passengers, then take off on horseback—only to be caught by a posse, also summoned by telegraph. At one point, a robber fires into the camera—a scene that had contemporary audiences ducking for cover.

NOSFERATU

F. W. Murnau, 1922

Murnau was a leading light of the German Expressionist movement, which emphasized style and symbolism, and this comes to the fore in his vampire movie *Nosferatu*. It is packed with memorable images, from the dark shadow of the vampire Count Orlok creeping through his castle to Orlok's look of terror as he faces the rising sun before vanishing. And in

Max Schreck, who played Orlok, the movie has a vampire like no other, one that is more rat than bat in appearance.

See also: *Sunrise* 30–31

DR. MABUSE THE GAMBLER

Fritz Lang, 1922

Nine years before making his serial-killer masterpiece, *M*, Fritz Lang explored his fascination with the criminal mind in this silent great of German Expressionist cinema. In doing so, he created the first movie archvillain: the manipulative mastermind Dr. Mabuse, who steals secret information to make a fortune on the stock exchange, and cheats at cards to rob the wealthy denizens of a decadent, degenerate society. Lang tapped into the mood of the Weimar-period Germany, which was in political and economic turmoil. His trick of revealing both the villain and his methods to the audience as a device to build suspense influenced Alfred Hitchcock.

See also: *Metropolis* 32–33 ■ *M* 46–47

THE JAZZ SINGER

Alan Crosland, 1927

The first full-length “talkie” feature movie, *The Jazz Singer* marked the beginning of a new era in cinema. There are about two minutes of synchronized dialogue, plus six memorable songs, mixed with intertitles. Al Jolson plays Jakie, who defies his religious Jewish father in order to pursue a dream of becoming a jazz singer. Jakie changes his name to Jack and adopts a “blackface” persona on stage. The story of an immigrant's struggle for identity is still a powerful one, but the blacking up makes the movie an uncomfortable watch for modern audiences.

UN CHIEN ANDALOU

Luis Buñuel, Salvador Dalí, 1929

The 16-minute short *Un Chien Andalou* (*An Andalusian Dog*) was the first movie by Spanish director Luis Buñuel, who made it in collaboration with Spanish Surrealist painter Salvador Dalí. It